

What is Multimedia Editing?

Currently, most – if not all – media content exists in digital form. File formats such as MP3, MP4, AVI etc. are commonly encountered by everyday users of media content. Each file format consists of a multitude of layered elements that have been incorporated for normal consumption. Video files include text, images, audio and video, and tend to be the most dense of all multimedia files. In this respect, audio and images are simpler and easier to work with. Within multimedia editing there are finer areas of audio and images editing, which require a different set of tools and skills to master. Multimedia editing is therefore the skill of being able to combine these various content files into a singular file type, usually a video file.



Even a simple audio editing tool can have various complex features to polish up the details

As little as 10-15 years ago, most multimedia content was edited without the use of computers. The first commercial tool for filmmakers that allowed for the use of digital editing was introduced by Lucasfilms and was called 'EditDroid'. This expensive and bulky piece of machinery allowed anyone who worked with film to convert it into a digital file and further edit it. Today, the same features and functionality can easily be found in free-to-use Open Source software such as 'Kdenlive'. Over the years, professional industry editors have switched over to the digital medium with the help of industry-grade software such as 'Final Cut Pro', 'Avid' and 'Adobe Premier Pro'.

It's also worth noting at this point that over the course of the last few years, there's been a remarkable rise in the amount of multimedia content being generated by users. With the ease of use and high quality provided by mobile devices, anyone can shoot and stitch together a movie and many people have.

Even though the number of competing software in the market is huge, only a handful of market leaders exist, and the general look and feel of these tools is similar. By developing the assortment of skills needed to work these software, anyone can master the art of multimedia editing.